



shares either and has now sent the said notice while putting on hold all further infusion of funds until shares are issued." The impasse has affected on-field performance, too, with some players not receiving salaries and thus reportedly boycotting training sessions. With just two wins in 17 games, the Black Panthers remain at the bottom of the table.

Surprises in IWL, I-League

In the second division, the I-League (men), Namdhari has taken centre stage, leading the standings after 10 games in just its second season in the league. Its striker, De has been one of its most lethal weapons, involved in eight of its 15 goals so far. On the other hand, Sreenidi Deccan, which finished as runner-up in the last two editions, has had a slump in form so far and remains fourth from bottom halfway into the season.

The Indian Women's League (IWL) started on January 10, and the usual suspects — Sethu FC, Gokulam Kerala

(GKFC) and defending champion Odisha FC — remain in the top half.

But East Bengal has been the surprise element and leads the standings with a 100 per cent win record after three games.

Under gaffer Anthony Andrews, who led GKFC to consecutive IWL titles, the Mashal Girls have the best offensive and defensive record (7 goals scored, one conceded), so far.

In a season where the men's side of East Bengal has struggled for consistency, the women could make the red-and-gold flag proud in its third season in India's highest division of women's football.

All standings in ISL, I-League and IWL are considered till January 26.

Neeladri Bhattacharjee

Tifo wars

The two oldest rivals of Indian football are back in the fight — not on the field but on the fringes. The skirmish is actually in the stands of the Salt Lake Stadium, where both

East Bengal and Mohun Bagan Super Giant fans are using huge tifos to convey their emotions and, at times, their frustrations.

With their team dominating the top spot for the last few weeks, Mohun Bagan fans have been working on various themes and record-breaking sizes to praise their players and cheer them on to glory.

On the other hand, East Bengal fans recently took a negative stance, seemingly venting their frustration at the team not being awarded a penalty during the derby in Guwahati (on January 11) when P.V. Vishnu's attempt struck Mohun Bagan midfielder Apuia's hand. Despite East Bengal's vehement appeals, the referee did not award a penalty.

The giant tifo (**above**) raised during the match against the Blasters depicted Mohun Bagan SG principal owner Sanjiv Goenka trying to influence the referee and asking him to ensure three points for his team. An obliging referee is shown asking